

1374

RISE OF NOH THEATRE

The Japanese Noh drama, one of the world's oldest theatrical traditions, rose to prominence after the actor Kan'ami Kiyotsugu and his son Zeami Motokiyo performed before Japan's ruler, shogun Ashikaga Yoshimitsu. Zeami became a favourite at court, creating many plays that established the modern form of the genre. A subtle mix of words, music, and gesture performed by actors in masks, Noh took a central place in Japan's unique culture.

▷ Noh mask, Mikazuki (male deity)



1360



◁ Ming dynasty coin

1368

MING EMPIRE PROCLAIMED

Born a poor peasant, Zhu Yuanzhang made himself leader of a Chinese popular revolt against the Mongol Yuan dynasty in the 1350s. In 1368, driving the Mongols from their capital at Beijing, he assumed the imperial throne as the Hongwu Emperor. He set out to restore Chinese Confucian traditions after the period of foreign rule and strengthened the centralized state, imposing his authority with brutal ruthlessness. The Ming dynasty that he founded was destined to rule China for almost three centuries.

◁ Emperor Hongwu, first ruler of the Ming dynasty

▽ Palace of the Popes, Avignon, France



1380 At the Battle of Kulikovo, Dmitri of Moscow defeats Tokhtamysh's Mongol Golden Horde